

1500rs.com

End-to-End UI/UX Design Case Study

Sole UI/UX Designer · February - March 2026 · Figma, Adobe Photoshop, Canva

ROLE	TIMELINE	PLATFORM
Sole UI/UX Designer	6 weeks, independent	Desktop & Mobile

Overview

Most budget hotels and homestays in Nepal are invisible online buried under listings for large hospitality brands, or not listed anywhere at all. 1500rs.com set out to fix that: a travel and accommodation platform built to surface quality stays under NPR 1,500 a night, while giving small hospitality businesses a real shot at digital visibility.

As the sole UI/UX designer, I owned the experience end to end research, information architecture, wireframes, the full visual design system, the booking flow, and the social/marketing assets that carried the brand beyond the site itself.

The Problem

Two groups were being underserved at once:

- Travelers had no reliable way to filter for genuinely affordable stays without wading through inflated "budget" listings on larger platforms.
- Small hotels and homestays had the rooms and the price point, but no digital storefront that could compete for attention.

The brief wasn't just "build a booking site" it was to build trust into every screen, since budget travelers are the most price- and scam-sensitive segment, and the smallest properties had the least brand recognition to lean on.

Goals

Business goals

- Give local hotels and homestays visibility they couldn't get on generic booking platforms.
- Build a platform travelers trust enough to book directly, rather than defaulting to a bigger brand.
- Make affordable domestic travel a realistic, plannable option.

User goals

- Find a stay that fits a firm budget, fast.
- Get enough real information about a property to book with confidence.
- Complete a booking without friction, on any device.

Process

1. Research & competitive analysis

I audited established travel and booking platforms to understand the patterns users already expect from a booking flow search, filter, listing detail, checkout and where those patterns broke down for a budget-first audience. The gap I kept

finding: competitors treated "budget" as a filter tucked away in advanced search, not a first-class part of the experience. That became the core design bet for 1500rs.com price transparency up front, not buried.

2. Information architecture

I structured the platform around how people actually plan budget trips not just "hotel or resort," but the full range of how someone might want to stay or spend a day:

- Hotels, Homestays, Resorts, Campsites
- Daycations for people who want an experience without an overnight stay
- Activities and Travel Packages for planning beyond just a room

Splitting these out early meant the navigation could stay simple while still covering very different trip intents a couple booking a weekend homestay and a family planning a full package needed different paths through the same site.

3. Wireframing & booking flow

Low-fidelity wireframes let me pressure-test the navigation, listing layout, and booking sequence before any visual design was locked in. The priority was cutting steps between "I found a place I like" and "I've booked it" every extra tap is a chance for a budget-conscious traveler to second-guess the price and bounce.

4. Design system

I built a shared design system typography scale, color palette, spacing, and reusable components so the same visual language held together across desktop, mobile, and every marketing graphic I produced. This wasn't just a style guide for its own sake: with requirements shifting frequently, a documented system meant I could rebuild screens fast without starting from zero each time, and it kept the developer handoff consistent.

Key Features Designed

Accommodation listings

Listing pages built around images, plain-language descriptions, amenities, and critically clear, upfront pricing, so "is this actually in my budget" is answered in seconds, not after three clicks.

Booking flow

A streamlined reservation flow designed to remove friction at every step, from property selection through confirmation, so budget travelers aren't given a reason to abandon the booking mid-way.

Packages & experiences

Dedicated sections for travel packages and daycations, for users planning around an experience rather than just a room.

Property information & trust signals

Because trust was the hardest problem on a budget platform, I designed dedicated sections that do the reassurance work a five-star hotel brand gets for free:

- "Why guests choose this stay" direct, specific reasons rather than generic marketing copy
- About the location, with context on what's actually nearby
- "Good for" tagging, so users self-select stays that match their trip type
- Amenities and highlights, presented consistently across every listing
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Marketing & social media

Beyond the platform itself, I designed social media creatives and promotional graphics to carry the same visual system into marketing channels, keeping the brand consistent wherever a potential traveler first encountered it.

Challenges

Affordability without looking cheap

Budget positioning can easily read as low-trust if the design isn't careful. I leaned on clean layout, consistent typography, and honest photography-forward listings rather than heavy discount-style visual cues, so "affordable" communicated "smart choice," not "corners cut."

Frequent requirement changes

Product requirements shifted several times during the six-week build. Rather than treat this as scope creep, I used the design system to absorb the changes because components and patterns were already documented, most revisions meant reassembling existing pieces rather than redesigning from scratch.

Owning the process solo

With no design team to split the work across, I had to sequence research, UX, visual design, and marketing assets myself without letting any one of them stall the others which meant getting comfortable making final calls quickly and moving on.

Outcome

1500rs.com launched as a working platform where budget travelers can search, compare, and book accommodations across Nepal with transparent pricing and where smaller hotels and homestays get a storefront built specifically for their kind of guest, not adapted from a template meant for large hotel chains.

Reflection

This project pushed me to hold an entire product's design UX, UI, and brand in my head at once, and to keep it coherent while requirements moved under me. It sharpened how I think about trust as a design problem, not just a content problem, and gave me real practice defending design decisions to stakeholders without a design lead to lean on.

Tools & Links

- Figma : UI design, prototyping, design system
- Adobe Photoshop : Social media poster
- Canva social: media graphics

Live site: 1500rs.com